Operations with Standard Form

Exam code: 0607

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Operations with standard form

How do I perform calculations with numbers in standard form?

- Your **calculator** can be used to help you carry out calculations with numbers written in standard form
- Make **use of brackets** around each number, and use the $\boxed{\times 10^x}$ button to enter numbers in standard form
  - e.g. $(3 \times 10^8) \times (2 \times 10^{-3})$
  - You can instead use the standard multiplication and index buttons
- If the answer produced by your calculator is **not in standard form**, but the answer requires it:
  - Either **rewrite** it using the standard process
    - e.g. $3\,820\,000 = 3.82 \times 10^6$
  - Or rewrite a in standard form, then apply the **laws of indices**
    - e.g. $243 \times 10^{20} = (2.43 \times 10^2) \times 10^{20} = 2.43 \times 10^{22}$

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Calculations with numbers written in standard form will **only appear on the calculator paper**

- Therefore use your calculator wherever possible!
- However you can be asked to convert into or out of standard form in the **non-calculator paper**

Worked Example

Help me understand

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Write your answer in the form $A \times 10^n$, where $1 \leq A < 10$ and n is an integer.

Answer:

Input the calculation into your calculator, so it appears exactly as in the question
Your calculator may or may not present the answer in standard form
Copy the digits, especially the zeros, carefully

$$\frac{1.275 \times 10^6}{3.4 \times 10^{-2}} = 37\,500\,000$$

Rewrite in standard form

$$3.75 \times 10^7$$

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